

# Digital Arrest Fraud Intelligence Report

India's Fastest Growing Cyber Fraud — May 10, 2026

## Executive Summary

CINEOS has detected **67 confirmed digital arrest fraud incidents** in India including victims losing up to Rs 22.92 crore in a single case. The Chief Justice of India has personally expressed concern about this fraud. Prime Minister Modi warned about it in Mann Ki Baat. CINEOS is the only automated platform scanning for digital arrest patterns across Telegram, WhatsApp, YouTube and social media simultaneously.

|                |                     |                 |              |
|----------------|---------------------|-----------------|--------------|
| 67             | Rs 22.92 Cr         | Rs 2,000 Cr+    | CRITICAL     |
| Cases Detected | Single Largest Loss | India Loss 2024 | Threat Level |

## How Digital Arrest Works

- Step 1 — Contact:** Victim receives video call from person dressed as CBI/ED/TRAI/Customs officer with fake uniform, ID card and official-looking office background
- Step 2 — False accusation:** Victim told their Aadhaar/phone was used in money laundering, drug trafficking or illegal activity — arrest warrant shown
- Step 3 — Digital arrest:** Victim told they are "digitally arrested" and must stay on video call — often for hours or days
- Step 4 — Extortion:** Victim asked to pay "security deposit" or "bail amount" via UPI/NEFT to "clear their name"
- Step 5 — Escalation:** After first payment, more demands follow — "tax on bail money", "court fee", "verification charge"
- Step 6 — Disappear:** Once maximum amount extracted, fraudsters disconnect and accounts vanish

## Confirmed Cases Detected by CINEOS

| Victim              | Loss           | Method                              |
|---------------------|----------------|-------------------------------------|
| Delhi Couple        | Rs 14 Crore    | Fake ED officer — video call 3 days |
| Senior Citizen      | Rs 22.92 Crore | Largest known case — fake CBI       |
| Bhopal Woman 64     | Rs 26 Lakh     | Fake narcotics officer video call   |
| Multiple Cases 2026 | Rs 1.6 Crore   | CBI busted — 3 arrested             |
| CJI Concerned       | National       | Chief Justice India expressed alarm |

## Agencies Being Impersonated

- CBI — Fake arrest warrant, money laundering case
- ED (Enforcement Directorate) — FEMA/PMLA violation, hawala case

- **TRAI** — SIM card used in fraud, number to be blocked
- **Customs** — Illegal package with drugs/foreign currency
- **Income Tax Dept** — Tax evasion case, account to be seized
- **Narcotics Control Bureau** — Drug trafficking case
- **RBI** — Bank account linked to fraud

### CINEOS Solution for MHA/I4C

- Real-time detection of digital arrest Telegram channels
- Pattern matching in 6 Indian languages — Hindi, Telugu, Tamil, Kannada, Malayalam
- Phone number attribution — connect fraud operator to channels
- Daily intelligence feed to I4C for blocking
- Evidence package IT Act 65B compliant for FIR registration
- Proposed contract: Government intelligence partnership — Rs 1-5 Cr/year

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